Say *more.*

Twelve minutes, two examiners and a partner. A plan for each part, and what to say when your mind goes blank.

Four parts · 12 minutes · with a partner

THE TEST AT A GLANCE

No. 02

Twelve minutes, four parts

PART 1 · 2–3 MIN

Interview

They ask about you. You're the expert.

PART 2 · 1 MIN EACH

Photo

You talk about a photo for a minute, on your own.

PART 3 · 2–3 MIN

Discussion

You and your partner choose something together.

PART 4 · 3 MIN

Conversation

More questions on the same topic.

One examiner talks to you. The other just listens and marks. Don't worry about the quiet one.

HOW YOU ARE MARKED

No. 03

What the examiner listens for

Grammar and Vocabulary

Do you have the words and grammar for everyday topics?

Discourse Management

Do you keep going, or stop after three words?

Pronunciation

Can people understand you? An accent is fine.

Interactive Communication

Do you talk with your partner, ask questions, react?

PART 1 · 2–3 MINUTES · INTERVIEW

No. 04

Never stop at one word

1. Practise your name, where you live and who you live with.
2. “Yes” isn’t an answer. “Yes, because…” is.
3. Add a reason, an example or a little story.
4. Listen for the time: *yesterday* means past, *next weekend* means future.
5. Didn’t catch it? “Sorry, could you say that again?” Totally fine.

“What do you do at weekends?”

ANSWER

I usually play football with my friends.

+ REASON

I love it because it helps me relax after school.

+ EXAMPLE

Last Saturday we played in the park and won!

Talk about the photo for a minute

1. Start with the big picture: where is it, and who's there?
2. Then the people: what are they doing, wearing, feeling?
3. Then the place: *there's a…*, *there are some…*
4. Not sure? Guess out loud: "They might be on holiday."
5. Keep going until the examiner says "Thank you".

USEFUL FRAMES

The photo shows…

In the background…

On the left, there's…

They might be…

It looks like…

Forgot a word? "It's a thing you use for…" works.

Talk it over, then choose

1. Listen to the situation. What are you choosing, and who is it for?
2. Go through the pictures: what you think, why, then ask your partner.
3. Start with the easy pictures. You don’t have to do them all.
4. Disagree if you want. Just be nice about it, and say why.
5. End with a choice: “I think the camping trip is **the best** because…”

SUGGEST

How about…? · Why don’t they…?

ASK

What do you think? · Do you agree?

AGREE

That’s true. · Exactly! · Me too.

DISAGREE

I’m not so sure. · Yes, but…

DECIDE

the best · the most useful · the most fun

Talk with your partner

Do

- Look at your partner, not the examiner.
- React: *Really? Good idea!*
- Ask: *What do you think?*
- Leave space for them to talk.

Don’t

- Talk the whole time.
- Sit in silence and wait.
- Give a speech.
- Panic if you disagree. That’s fine.

Think of it as a chat with a friend who happens to be in the same exam.

PART 4 · 3 MINUTES · DISCUSSION

Your opinion, with reasons

1. The questions are on the same topic as Part 3.
2. Give your opinion and the reason. Don’t wait to be asked “why?”
3. Use your own life: “When I went to Córdoba last year…”
4. Bring your partner in: “And you?”, “Do you agree?”
5. Both run out of ideas? The examiner will ask something new.

THE FORMULA

Opinion
I’d prefer… / In my opinion…

+ Reason
because… / so…

+ Example
For example, last summer…

WHEN YOU GET STUCK

No. 09

Phrases for emergencies

DIDN’T UNDERSTAND

“Sorry, could you repeat that, please?”

NEED TIME

“Hmm, let me think…”

FORGOT A WORD

“It’s something you use for…”

MADE A MISTAKE

“Sorry, I mean…” and carry on.

NOTHING TO SAY

“What do you think about it?”

WANT TO ADD MORE

“Also… Another thing is…”

Everyone makes mistakes in this test. Keep talking. That’s what they mark.

Say more than you need to.

Good luck.